



Preparing the First AI-Native Generation

5 Signs Your Child Is (or Isn't) AI-Ready

A Quick Checklist for Parents

Discover whether your child is developing the skills needed to thrive in an AI-driven world.

“

AI readiness is not about teaching children how to use AI. It is about teaching them how to think, create, question, and stay human.

— Miss JOY

”

By Miss JOY

AI Literacy Educator &
Founder of AI Explorers Academy



Irene Dostov





Preparing the First AI-Native Generation

Before We Begin...

Many parents assume AI readiness means knowing how to use ChatGPT, AI apps, or the latest technology.

It doesn't.

AI readiness is less about technology and more about developing the human skills children will need in a world where AI is becoming part of everyday life.

The good news?

Most of these skills can be nurtured at home through simple conversations, play, creativity, and meaningful relationships.

This checklist is designed to help you reflect on where your child is today—and identify opportunities for growth.



Quick Instructions

For each statement in this guide, simply check:

- ☐ Often
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely

There are no right or wrong answers.

This is not a test.

It's a conversation starter.

What You'll Assess



Curiosity

Does your child ask questions and explore new ideas?



Critical Thinking

Can your child explain their thinking and question information?



Creativity

Does your child create more than they consume?



Human Connection

Does your child build healthy relationships and show empathy?



Confidence

Is your child developing the mindset needed to navigate a changing world?

“

AI readiness is not about raising children who can use AI.

It is about raising children who can think, create, question, and stay human in a world shaped by AI.

— Miss JOY

”





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SIGN #1

Your Child Asks Questions

☐ Often ☐ Sometimes ☐ Rarely



EXAMPLES

- Why does this happen?
- How does that work?
- What would happen if...?



WHY IT MATTERS

Curiosity is the foundation of future learning. Children who ask questions are more likely to become thoughtful users and creators of AI rather than passive consumers.

SIGN #2

Your Child Can Explain Their Thinking

☐ Often ☐ Sometimes ☐ Rarely

EXAMPLES

- I chose this because...
- I think this is true because...
- My idea is...



WHY IT MATTERS

AI can generate answers. Humans must learn how to reason. The ability to explain thinking is becoming increasingly valuable.

“

The best way to prepare children for an AI-powered future is not to teach them more technology, but to nurture their ability to think for themselves.

— Miss JOY

”





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SIGN #3

Your Child Creates More Than They Consume

☐ Often ☐ Sometimes ☐ Rarely



EXAMPLES

- Draws stories
- Builds things
- Invents games
- Creates songs
- Writes ideas



WHY IT MATTERS

The future belongs to creators, not just consumers.

AI can help create, but children still need imagination and initiative.

SIGN #4

Your Child Questions Information

☐ Often ☐ Sometimes ☐ Rarely



EXAMPLES

- How do we know?
- Is that really true?
- Where did that information come from?



WHY IT MATTERS

One of the most important skills in the AI era is learning not to believe everything immediately.

Critical thinking protects children from misinformation.

“

When children learn to ask the right questions, think deeply, and create boldly, they become ready for any future.

— Miss JOY

”



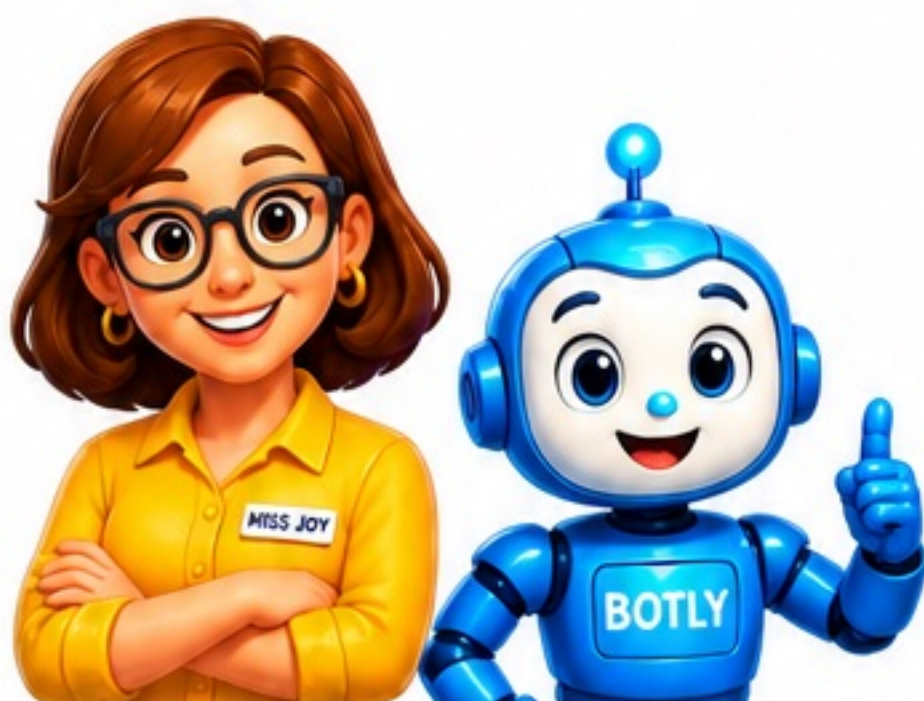


Preparing the First AI-Native Generation

SIGN #5

Your Child Values Human Relationships

☐ Often ☐ Sometimes ☐ Rarely



EXAMPLES

- Enjoys conversations
- Shows empathy
- Helps others
- Builds friendships



WHY IT MATTERS

AI can process information, but it cannot replace meaningful human connection. The future may be powered by AI, but it will always be shaped by relationships.



YOU'RE DOING GREAT!

AI readiness is a journey, not a destination. Every small step you take today helps your child build the skills they need for tomorrow.

Use this checklist to celebrate strengths, spot growth opportunities, and start meaningful conversations with your child.

You are your child's first and most important guide.

Thank you for investing in their future. 

“

The skills that will help children thrive in the AI era are timelessly human: curiosity, creativity, critical thinking, compassion, and courage.

— Miss JOY

”





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Your Results & Next Steps

Add up your answers for each sign.

Use the guide below to understand your results.

YOUR SCORE	WHAT IT MEANS
 12 – 15 You're on track!	Your child is showing strong signs of AI readiness . Keep nurturing these skills and celebrating their growth!
 8 – 11 You're building momentum!	Your child is developing important skills that will serve them well. Focus on consistency and provide opportunities to grow.
 4 – 7 Room to grow!	There are great opportunities to strengthen these skills . Small, intentional steps can create a big impact.
 0 – 3 Let's get started!	Every journey begins with awareness . You're already taking the most important first step!



WHAT YOU CAN DO NEXT

- ✓ **Celebrate strengths.**
Notice what your child does well and encourage it.
- ✓ **Have conversations.**
Ask open-ended questions and really listen.
- ✓ **Create opportunities.**
Give your child time, tools, and freedom to explore and create.
- ✓ **Be a role model.**
Show curiosity, kindness, and a growth mindset.
- ✓ **Keep learning together.**
Explore AI literacy as a family and grow side by side.

“

The future isn't something that happens to our children.

It's something we help them prepare for—together.

Thank you for being their first guide on this journey.

— Miss JOY

”



Thank you for investing in your child's future.

Together, let's prepare the first AI-native generation to **imagine**, **create**, and **lead** with heart. ♥



Irene Dostov